

Parent Guide — middle / module-13- indic-ecology

IKS Curriculum

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Parent Guide — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Middle)

What is your child learning?

Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam — “the world is one family” — from the Mahā Upaniṣad (6.71–73) anchors the Indian ecological tradition. Combined with the Pṛthivī Sūkta (Atharva Veda 12.1), Iṣopaniṣad mantra 1, and Bhagavad Gītā 3.10–14 on *yajña* as ecological cycle, students encounter classical frameworks and apply them to modern climate and sustainability challenges.

Why this matters

This module is part of an Indian Knowledge Systems curriculum that introduces classical Indian frameworks alongside their modern-scientific parallels. Your child will learn to (a) name and use precise Sanskrit terms, (b) understand the observational basis for the classical framework, and (c) relate it to current scientific or scholarly understanding.

What you can do at home

This module connects classical ecological wisdom with the current climate crisis. Talk with your child about local environmental concerns — water, waste, trees in your area — and how your family already practices small acts of conservation.

Conversation prompts

Try one of these over a meal or walk:

1. “What’s one Sanskrit word you learned this week? What does it mean?”
2. “What did you find surprising in this module?”
3. “Is there anything you’re not sure about? Let’s look it up together.”
4. “How would you explain this to your grandmother / grandfather?”

Questions parents often ask

Q: Is this religious instruction? A: No. The module presents Indian classical frameworks (cosmology, mathematics, astronomy, ecology) as historical knowledge systems with their own logic and method. The framing is scholarly and comparative, not devotional.

Q: Will my child be tested on Sanskrit? A: Sanskrit terms are introduced for precision, not for rote memorisation. The summative quiz asks students to *use* the terms — for example, “Which *doṣa* is dominant in the morning hours?” — rather than translate them.

Q: How does this connect to NCERT / board syllabus? A: This module supplements (does not replace) NCERT content. NEP 2020 §4.6 calls for the integration of Indian Knowledge Systems. The pack’s `README.md` lists the specific NEP principles each module advances.

Reading further (for parents)

See `sources.md` in this pack for the full source list.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 13 (Middle) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

At a glance

Day	Session title	Lesson file	Activity / assessment
1	<i>Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam</i> — One Family	<code>days/day-01-vasudhaiva-kutumbakam.md</code>	Whole-class chart: “what is a family?”
2	Five Elements Revisited	<code>days/day-02-five-elements-revisited.md</code>	Element-as-family-member diagram; exit ticket
3	Rivers as Sacred — Protection by Reverence	<code>days/day-03-rivers-sacred.md</code>	River-map activity; formative quiz
4	Sacred Groves	<code>days/day-04-sacred-groves.md</code>	<code>activities/activity-01-sacred-grove-mapping.md</code>
5	<i>Yajña</i> — The Ecological Cycle	<code>days/day-05-yajna-cycle.md</code>	Mid-module check; cycle-diagram
6	<i>Pr̥thivī Sūkta</i> — Earth as Mother	<code>days/day-06-prithivi-sukta.md</code>	Imagery worksheet; reflection
7	<i>Iṣopaniṣad</i> Mantra 1 — Use, Don’t Grab	<code>days/day-07-isopanishad-mantra.md</code>	Group discussion; “what do I take without asking?”

Day	Session title	Lesson file	Activity / assessment
8	Climate Change Basics	days/day-08-climate-change.md	IPCC summary read-aloud; project plan due
9	From Ancient to Action — Neighbourhood Walk	days/day-09-neighbourhood-walk.md	activities/activity-02-eco-walk.md
10	Project Pitch + Summative	days/day-10-project-pitch.md	quizzes/summative.md + 3-min pitches

Pacing notes

- Days 1–4 are introductory and observation-heavy. If a class is unfamiliar with Module 2, spend 5 extra minutes on Day 2 reviewing the *pañcabhūta*.
- Day 5 (Gītā 3.10–14) and Day 7 (Īśa Up. mantra 1) involve student reading of short translated verses. Print them in advance; do not ask students to read Sanskrit cold.
- Day 8 (climate change) is content-heavy. If your class needs more, split it across Day 7’s final 10 min and a full Day 8.
- Day 9’s walk depends on weather and your campus context. If the walk is impossible, run a “virtual walk” using photos from the past month — outcome is the same.

Suggested running theme

Open each class with the same question on the board: **“Who in nature gave you something today, and did you give anything back?”** Two students share for 30 seconds each. This is the *yajña* habit in plain words.

Formative vs. summative weight

- Formative quizzes (Days 3 and 5) — diagnostic, not graded. Hand back within 24 hours.
- Summative quiz (Day 10) — see rubric in `assessments/rubric.md`. Combined with project, total 40 marks.

What students leave the module with

- Three Sanskrit phrases in their own handwriting, with meaning: *vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam*, *yajña*, *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvam*.
- A drawn or written record of one local environmental observation.
- One specific small action — planted, signed, repaired, repeated, or refused.
- The habit of noticing what they take from the environment and what they give back.

Cross-module links

- **Module 2 (Panchabhūta)** — Day 2 explicitly reuses the five-element framework.
- **Module 6 (Moon Phases)** — seasonal festivals as ecological calendar; mentioned in Day 3 only.

- **Module 8 (Yoga)** — *ahimsā* as an ethical principle appears as the first *yama* in Patañjali's eight limbs; mentioned in Day 7.

Homework

Homework — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Middle)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 10–15 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
2. **Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
3. **Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
4. **Day 4 — Sacred Groves** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
5. **Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
6. **Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
7. **Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
8. **Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
9. **Day 9 — From Ancient to Action** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)
10. **Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment** · Write 2 sentences about today's concept. (~10 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.